produce to India from Pakistan either being looted before it could leave or contaminated by the time it arrived.

The most troubling potential obstacle to the viability of this Kashmir solution is the possibility of the election in India of another BJP-led central government in the foreseeable future, especially were it dominated by anti-Muslim Hindutva extremists like Narendra Modi. This hypothetical possibility would dangerously diminish the prospects of permanent Indo-Pakistani peace, without which no solution for Kashmir is possible. Hopefully, the majority of India's electorate will, however, continue to prefer progressively tolerant leaders rather than narrowly bigoted ones, peacemakers rather than warmongers, choosing a bright and promising future rather than reverting to ancient, deadly religious conflicts. Pakistan, of course, must also firmly establish a democratic civil government capable of maintaining the support and respect of its military leaders in subduing Islamic militants and Taliban extremists.

"If the leaders of Pakistan have the courage, the determination and the statesmanship to take this road to peace," Prime Minister Singh encouraged them on 9 June 2009, "I wish to assure them that we will meet them more than half way."[1] A month later, accepting an honorary doctorate from Jammu University, Manmohan Singh reiterated the theme of peace, saying, "I hope and believe that Jammu and Kashmir can, one day, become a symbol of India-Pakistan cooperation rather than of conflict. . . . Borders cannot be changed, but they can be made irrelevant. . . the Line of Control can become a line of peace with a free flow of ideas, goods, services and people."[2]

The 10th International Kashmir Peace Conference, held in Washington, D.C., on 23–24 July 2009, under the auspices of the Kashmiri American Council, led by Dr. Ghulam Nabi Fai, and the Association of Humanitarian Lawyers USA, led by Dr. Karen Parker, unanimously urged "the cessation of militarization and human rights violations" throughout Kashmir.[3] The Kashmir Peace Conference received and heard messages from all top Kashmir leaders, including those detained in jails—Syed Ali Geelani and Shabir Ahmed Shah—and from those under house arrest, including Mirwaiz Umar Farooq and Muhammad Yasin Malik. These courageous Kashmiri leaders "called upon the global leadership to impress on the Government of India" the urgent need "to end its reign of terror in Kashmir, release all political